

CSS Committee Meeting - Minutes

Location:	Online (Discord)
Date:	Thursday 20th August
Time:	17:00 BST
Attendees:	Joe Adams (JA) (Chair), Henry Thomas (HT) (Minuting), Idris Evans (IE), Albert Waldron (AW), Harry Wake (HW), Anna Charleton (AC), George Tong (GT), Evie Wilson (EW), Jacob Swales (JS), Day Jones (DJ)

- 1 Apologies JA
- 2 Adoption of Previous Minutes HT
 - Unanimous adoption of previous minutes
- 3 Matters Arising All
 - **Hoodies**
 - **Action GT:** Put message out for hoodie pickups in September
 - **Action completed**
 - Most have now been collected, can send a message later in the term if any are not collected later on
 - **Membership renewals**
 - New renewals - probably majority in fresher's week from the events
 - **Fresher's Week**
 - **Societies Fair Stall (23rd & 24th September)**
 - **Action GT:** Create calendar for this year using the template
 - **Action completed**
 - **Action DJ:** Find out how much new banners would cost - EPS Exhibitions
 - **Action completed**
 - Would be £50 + VAT (down from £75)
 - HW says look at other places as seems expensive
 - **Annual RA**
 - **Action AW and HT:** Look through and remove old events no longer run and add any new events.
 - **Action in progress**
 - **UG talks**
 - 11:00-13:00, 15:00-17:00
 - In new Munrow lecture theatre
 - **Societies Fair**
 - Put availability for fresher's on spreadsheet
 - Add comment if not available at any point
 - EPS College society fair stand in week 1, will need to wait for timetables to be out

- **MSc Induction talk**
 - 10:00-12:00
 - Same place as UG talks
- **PGR talks**
 - No reply about times yet
- **Committee Bios**
 - Will be pushed on the 31st August
 - Meet the committee in early September

4 Committee Handover All

5 Past Events All

6 Future Events (*standing item*) All

- **Fresher's Week**
 - **Mixers**
 - **First Year Mixer**
 - GT and HT say it was directly after one of our lectures last year
 - JA posits pub night fresher's and mixers week 1
 - AC says pub night and mixers were different, but could be very similar depending on how they're run which may make one pointless
 - **PGR Mixer**
 - Are running it jointly with the school's PG Reps to get better attendance
 - **International Mixer**
 - Unlikely to be doable as we don't have an international rep, and the school run one of their own
 - IE says the school does run one
 - AW asks for a volunteer to go to the school's international student mixer
 - **Board games night**
 - Need to contact the school about use of the building and games and purchasing alcohol
 - Tabletop society said they might be there but have not confirmed yet
 - AW will ask person he knows who knows the current president if no reply from them soon
 - **Action JA:**
 - Contact the school about board games night
 - **Pub**
 - JA suggests Soak as the food is better and better for getting to know people
 - DJ suggests Joe's is cheaper
 - JS and AW say Joe's will be rammed on friday night in fresher's
 - HT says it was in week 1 last year
 - HW suggests doing both
 - JA says this could be one at both (Joe's and Soak)
 - AC says it could put people off if we don't have enough committee and have things on too often

- JA says figure out the day we are going to do it on, but week 1 is probably better
 - GT asks what time it would be
 - JA says it is usually earlier than the regular pub nights so probably 7
- **Societies night**
 - **Action AW:** Contact Robotics and OStem
 - **Action completed**
 - Activity done on guild website
- **Fresher's Quiz**
 - **Action HT:** Create a smaller quiz for first week to get people in the building
 - **Action completed**
 - **Action AW:** Message Todd for alcohol and booking the atrium
 - **Action carried forwards**
 - Could be done on thursday as nothing else is planned
 - No rush for times, but need to let the school know
- **Scavenger Hunt**
 - Guild activity submitted
 - Not got questions for it, as the same one was used for 3 years
 - **Action HW:** Create scavenger hunt question sheet about the university
 - GT asks when it will be
 - JA says pretty much throughout the week
 - HW asks about publicity for it, and suggests a QR about it on the stand we have
 - JA agrees, and says it needs more advertising
- **Park/Winterbourne**
 - Going to an outdoor place for a casual sober meeting at a weekend
 - JA says fresher's week is packed, so this would be good for a weekend
 - JA suggests the park and continuing with winterbourne in the second semester
 - Suggestions:
 - Selly Park - Longer walk
 - Green space on the vale
 - Green space behind the guild, but will probably have the tent up still
 - Space behind the Watson building
- **CSS Lunch**
 - Alfred Works have replied about doing Tuesday but needs £100 deposit
 - Deposit is converted to bar tab or QR vouchers
 - JA will email again to confirm what that means, and try to convince them to change their idea
 - JA says it is doable with the sponsorship incoming
 - St Paul's have replied but can't do Tuesday
 - Hopefully can get more people this year with more advertising
 - Need to wait for them to respond to decide next steps
- **Other events**

- **Action ML:** Reach out to VGS to ask about an early collab
 - **Action pending**
- **Break;**
 - Will figure out day and time, and the source of the food and drink for it soon
 - Won't start it immediately as people won't have much work
 - DJ says they might be able to get a costco card and will have a car at uni to get food
 - GT asks what food?
 - JA says usually biscuits, crisps, and other foods, but milk is a problem. UHT has been suggested as an alternative.
 - GT asks if costco is likely to be much cheaper
 - HT asks if the fuel for the trip has been accounted for when working out which is cheaper
 - IE might be able to run it depending on time
- **CSS Plush Making**
 - **Action AW:** Message Fearne to start planning it if possible
 - **Action in progress**
 - Message has been sent but no reply
 - Fearne did send a list of the items required previously
 - Could reach out to members to see if any of them know how to crochet
- **PUB**
 - AW and HT will try to run it between them
 - Making sure pub is booked and publicity done
- **Outlines for major events**
 - EGM
 - Roles to fill:
 - International Rep
 - First Year Rep
 - PGT Rep (Maddy stepping down by then)
 - EDI Officer
 - Anyone is welcome to step down if they need to at any point, it is a lot of work
 - If anyone wants to swap roles, let JA know ahead of time
 - Need 2 weeks in advance and a room booked
 - Need to set up the website, and everyone who has worked on it previously is not on committee
 - Was week 4/5 last year, before halloween quiz
 - Will confirm with Matty about the guild's view on the website
 - Wed 21st October, 13:00 onwards provisionally
 - Halloween quiz
 - **Action HT:** Make quiz
 - **Action pending**
 - Thursday 29th October, 18:00 onwards provisionally
 - Need to get good prizes for it
 - Have too many halloween TeX stickers
 - Have holographic TeX for costume competition
 - Always get blahaj for the winners, but could look at others depending on price

- Will need to make the school aware for the microphone system and Todd for alcohol
 - Small blahaj is £5
 - 10cm alien is £2
- Christmas meal
- TNMOC
- Hackathon
- Ball
- NQ64
- **Publicity**
 - GT will do calendar
 - EW says separate posts for each event and can do discord and instagram for that
 - HW will do scavenger hunt announcement
 - EW will send link to formatter website
 - Make event in discord when doing an announcement
 - Need to make sure announcements are out early

7 Sponsor/Industry Update (*standing item*) HW

- **2026 sponsorship collateral update**
- **Outreach strategy and committee involvement in the sponsor selection process**
- **Pipeline and active discussions**
- New proposal - Adding the name and certain details into the proposal to personalise it per company
- Also made a video to show we are serious
- Have contacted (nearly) all the past sponsors
- Have done a large amount more this morning for second round:
 - Various tech companies in Birmingham, including some startups
 - The companies who are regulars at the careers fairs

8 Finance Report (*standing item*) IE

- **Most recent statement balance: £250.15**
- **Actual working balance: £255.49**
- **Pending incomings**
 - **Memberships**
- **Pending outgoings**
 - **Server rental**
 - **Stickers**
 - Draft of a grant application written
- Other grant applications also in progress, deadline is 31st August
- IE asks about purchasing the t-shirts
- JA says probably early September as all sponsors before the 1st September need to be on them
- JA says that smaller orders more often is better, to save having too many left over
- IE asks about asking for a grant for half of the money, and the school paying the other half
- JA agrees this is a good idea
- IE says there is a grant for the server and website costs which he has calculated based on last year

- School say they will give a set amount of money, which we spend and then ask for specific things to spend that money on rather than being given a lump sum
- GT suggests asking for more money as the number of students is increasing (and we had no sponsors last year)

9 EDI Report (*standing item*) All

10 Committee Suggestions (*standing item*) All

- **Action DJ:** Make the poll for it in announcements, pinging the minecraft role
 - **Action pending**
- Do a poll for if people want it, and a poll for mod packs and other options so people have a choice
- 4 cores and 4-8GB of RAM to run on Hetzner probably
- IE says last year's cost is on the bill so can be included in the grant request
- DJ says they might be able to run it locally
- JS says Hetzner have roughly tripled their prices since last time so alternatives may be better

11 Any Other Business (*standing item*) All

- **Tex bot changes**
 - **Action JS:** Organise discussion outside meeting and plan the potential changes
 - **Action carried forwards**
- **Other meetings over summer**
 - **Action AW:** Poll for potential meeting or availability
 - **Action completed**
- **Publicity**
 - **Action TK:** Make graduation graphic soon
 - **Action completed**
- **Next meeting**
 - At some point not long before fresher's week
 - **Action JA:** LettuceMeet link for next meeting
- **Email to all students**
 - Can't do postcard to students
 - Original message was too long but has been cut down
 - Has some dates and times in but they may change
 - GT asks if the school will be able to advertise us nearer fresher's week
 - JA says he thinks Todd is the person to ask

Actual start time 17:03 BST
Actual end time 18:37 BST
Duration 1 Hours 34 Minutes